

Linear algebra: Exercise session 3

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1. In a garden there are only rabbits and chickens. After counting there appear to be 108 legs and 39 heads. How many chickens and rabbits are in the garden?

2. Describe the set of solutions of the following systems by Gauss-Jordan elimination algorithm:

(a) $\begin{cases} 3x_1 + 2x_2 = 5, \\ 6x_1 + 3x_2 = 7, \end{cases}$

(b) $\begin{cases} 3x_1 + 2x_2 + 4x_3 = 5, \\ x_1 + x_2 - 3x_3 = 2, \\ 4x_1 + 3x_2 + x_3 = 7, \end{cases}$

(c) $\begin{cases} x_1 + 2x_2 + x_3 = 0, \\ x_1 - x_2 + 2x_3 = 1, \\ 3x_1 + 5x_3 = 3, \end{cases}$

(d) $\begin{cases} 2x_1 + 3x_2 + x_3 = 1, \\ x_1 + x_2 + x_3 = 3, \\ 3x_1 + 4x_2 + 2x_3 = 4, \end{cases}$

(e) $\begin{cases} x_1 + 2x_2 + x_3 = 11, \\ 2x_1 + x_2 - x_3 = 1, \\ x_1 - x_2 + 3x_3 = 10, \end{cases}$

(f) $A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 3 & 1 \\ 4 & 7 & 5 \\ 0 & -2 & 2 \end{bmatrix}, b = \begin{bmatrix} 8 \\ 20 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}.$

Answer.

(a)

$$\left[\begin{array}{cc|c} 3 & 2 & 5 \\ 6 & 3 & 7 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_1 \rightarrow \frac{1}{3}r_1} \left[\begin{array}{cc|c} 1 & \frac{2}{3} & \frac{5}{3} \\ 6 & 3 & 7 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_2 \rightarrow r_2 - 6r_1} \left[\begin{array}{cc|c} 1 & \frac{2}{3} & \frac{5}{3} \\ 0 & -1 & -3 \end{array} \right]$$

$$\xrightarrow{r_2 \rightarrow -r_2} \left[\begin{array}{cc|c} 1 & \frac{2}{3} & \frac{5}{3} \\ 0 & 1 & 3 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_1 \rightarrow r_1 - \frac{2}{3}r_2} \left[\begin{array}{cc|c} 1 & 0 & \frac{-1}{3} \\ 0 & 1 & 3 \end{array} \right].$$

$$x_1 = \frac{-1}{3}, \quad x_2 = 3.$$

The system is consistent and has a unique solution $x^* = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{-1}{3} \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}.$

(b)

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 3 & 2 & 4 & 5 \\ 1 & 1 & -3 & 2 \\ 4 & 3 & 1 & 7 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_1 \leftrightarrow r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 1 & -3 & 2 \\ 3 & 2 & 4 & 5 \\ 4 & 3 & 1 & 7 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{\substack{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 - 4r_1 \\ r_2 \rightarrow r_2 - 3r_1}} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 1 & -3 & 2 \\ 0 & -1 & 13 & -1 \\ 0 & -1 & 13 & -1 \end{array} \right]$$

$$\xrightarrow{r_2 \rightarrow -r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 1 & -3 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & -13 & 1 \\ 0 & -1 & 13 & -1 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 + r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 1 & -3 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & -13 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_1 \rightarrow r_1 - r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 0 & 10 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & -13 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{array} \right].$$

$$x_1 + 10x_3 = 1, \quad x_2 - 13x_3 = 1, \quad x_3 \text{ free.}$$

$$x = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + t \begin{pmatrix} -10 \\ 13 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad t \in \mathbb{R}.$$

The system is consistent and has infinitely many solutions.

(c)

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 2 & 1 \\ 3 & 0 & 5 & 3 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_2 \rightarrow r_2 - r_1} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 & 1 & 1 \\ 3 & 0 & 5 & 3 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 - 3r_1} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & -6 & 2 & 3 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 - 2r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right].$$

The last row corresponds to the equation $0x_1 + 0x_2 + 0x_3 = 1$, which is impossible.

Hence the system is inconsistent and has no solution.

(d)

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 2 & 3 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 & 3 \\ 3 & 4 & 2 & 4 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_1 \leftrightarrow r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 1 & 1 & 3 \\ 2 & 3 & 1 & 1 \\ 3 & 4 & 2 & 4 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow[r_2 \rightarrow r_2 - 2r_1]{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 - 3r_1} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 1 & 1 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & -5 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & -5 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 - r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 1 & 1 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & -5 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{array} \right]$$

$$\xrightarrow{r_1 \rightarrow r_1 - r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 0 & 2 & 8 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 & -5 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{array} \right]$$

$$x_1 + 2x_3 = 8, \quad x_2 - x_3 = -5, \quad x_3 \text{ free.}$$

$$x = \begin{pmatrix} 8 \\ -5 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + t \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad t \in \mathbb{R}.$$

The system is consistent and has infinitely many solutions (one free parameter t).

(e)

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & 1 & 11 \\ 2 & 1 & -1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 & 3 & 10 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow[r_2 \rightarrow r_2 - 2r_1]{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 - r_1} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & 1 & 11 \\ 0 & -3 & -3 & -21 \\ 0 & -3 & 2 & -1 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_2 \rightarrow -r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & 1 & 11 \\ 0 & 3 & 3 & 21 \\ 0 & -3 & 2 & -1 \end{array} \right]$$

$$\xrightarrow{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 + r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & 1 & 11 \\ 0 & 3 & 3 & 21 \\ 0 & 0 & 5 & 20 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow[r_2 \rightarrow r_2 - \frac{3}{5}r_3]{r_1 \rightarrow r_1 - \frac{1}{5}r_3} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & 0 & 7 \\ 0 & 3 & 0 & 8 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 4 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow[r_1 \rightarrow r_1 - \frac{2}{3}r_2]{r_2 \rightarrow \frac{1}{3}r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & \frac{8}{3} \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 4 \end{array} \right]$$

$$x_1 = 1, \quad x_2 = \frac{8}{3}, \quad x_3 = 4$$

$$\text{The system is consistent and has a unique solution } x^* = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 8/3 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}.$$

(f)

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 2 & 3 & 1 & 8 \\ 4 & 7 & 5 & 20 \\ 0 & -2 & 2 & 0 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_2 \rightarrow r_2 - 2r_1} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 2 & 3 & 1 & 8 \\ 0 & 1 & 3 & 4 \\ 0 & -2 & 2 & 0 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 + 2r_2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 2 & 3 & 1 & 8 \\ 0 & 1 & 3 & 4 \\ 0 & 0 & 8 & 8 \end{array} \right]$$

$$\xrightarrow[r_1 \rightarrow r_1 - 3r_2]{r_3 \rightarrow r_3/8} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 2 & 0 & -8 & -4 \\ 0 & 1 & 3 & 4 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow[r_1 \rightarrow r_1 + 8r_3]{r_2 \rightarrow r_2 - 3r_3} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 2 & 0 & 0 & 4 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{array} \right] \xrightarrow{r_1 \rightarrow r_1/2} \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 0 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

$$x_1 = 2, \quad x_2 = 1, \quad x_3 = 1$$

The system is consistent and has a unique solution $x^* = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}$.

3. Suppose the matrix $A \in \mathbb{R}^{4 \times 4}$ is defined as the product of three squared matrices, i.e.,

$$A = BCD = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & -2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Solve $Ax = [12 \ 6 \ 32 \ 2]^T$ for $x \in \mathbb{R}^4$.

Answer.

$$Ax = b \Rightarrow BCDx = b \Rightarrow Dx = z, \quad Cz = y, \quad By = b$$

Step 1: Solve $By = b$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} y_1 \\ y_2 \\ y_3 \\ y_4 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 12 \\ 6 \\ 32 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} \Rightarrow y = \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ 2 \\ 30 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

Step 2: Solve $Cz = y$

$$\begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & -2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} z_1 \\ z_2 \\ z_3 \\ z_4 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ 2 \\ 30 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} \Rightarrow z = \begin{bmatrix} -4 \\ 1 \\ -10 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Step 3: Solve $Dx = z$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ x_3 \\ x_4 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -4 \\ 1 \\ -10 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} \Rightarrow x = \begin{bmatrix} -4 \\ 9 \\ -23 \\ 58 \end{bmatrix}$$

The system is consistent and has a unique solution $x^* = \begin{pmatrix} -4 \\ 9 \\ -23 \\ 58 \end{pmatrix}$.

4. Computers are really efficient in doing matrix operations. This is the reason we convert mathematical operations into matrix operations. We are interested to convert operations like *scaling row*, *sum of two rows* and *swap two rows* into multiplication of a squared matrix with augmented matrix, i.e. $P * A$.

Considering augmented matrix A ,

$$A = \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} a_{11} & a_{12} & a_{13} & b_1 \\ a_{21} & a_{22} & a_{23} & b_2 \\ a_{31} & a_{32} & a_{33} & b_3 \end{array} \right].$$

Find the matrix P for the following operations:

- (a) $r_1 \leftrightarrow r_2$
- (b) $r_3 \leftrightarrow r_2$
- (c) $r_1 + r_2 \rightarrow r_1$
- (d) $cr_1 \rightarrow r_1$
- (e) $ar_2 + br_3 \rightarrow r_2$

Answer.

(a) $r_1 \leftrightarrow r_2$:

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

(b) $r_3 \leftrightarrow r_2$:

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

(c) $r_1 + r_2 \rightarrow r_1$:

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

(d) $cr_1 \rightarrow r_1$:

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} c & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

(e) $ar_2 + br_3 \rightarrow r_2$:

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & a & b \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

5. Write a Python program that:

- (a) asks the user to enter a matrix A (the coefficient matrix) and a vector b (the constant terms on the right-hand side of the equations);
- (b) applies the **Gauss–Jordan elimination algorithm** to solve the linear system $Ax = b$;
- (c) determines and displays whether the system:
 - has a **unique solution** x^* ,
 - has **infinitely many solutions**, or
 - has **no solution**.

Answer.

Listing 1: Solving Linear System of Equations via Gauss-Jordan

```
1 import numpy as np
2
3
4 # Gauss-Jordan elimination function
5 def gauss_jordan(A, b):
6     A = A.astype(float)
7     b = b.astype(float)
8     n = len(b)
9     aug = np.hstack([A, b.reshape(-1, 1)])
10    print("\nInitial augmented matrix:\n", aug, "\n")
11
12    for i in range(n):
13        pivot = aug[i, i]
14        if np.isclose(pivot, 0):
15            for j in range(i+1, n):
16                if not np.isclose(aug[j, i], 0):
17                    aug[[i, j]] = aug[[j, i]]
18                    pivot = aug[i, i]
19                    print(f"Swapped row {i+1} with row {j+1}:\n", aug, "\n")
20                    break
21            if np.isclose(pivot, 0):
22                continue
23            aug[i] = aug[i] / pivot
24            print(f"Scaled row {i+1} to make pivot 1:\n", aug, "\n")
25            for j in range(n):
```

```

26         if j != i:
27             aug[j] = aug[j] - aug[j, i] * aug[i]
28             print(f"Eliminated element in row {j+1}, column {i+1}:\n", aug, "\n")
29
30     print("Final reduced row-echelon form:\n", aug, "\n")
31
32     for i in range(n):
33         if np.all(np.isclose(aug[i, :-1], 0)) and not np.isclose(aug[i, -1], 0):
34             print("The system has no solution.")
35             return None
36
37     rank = np.sum(~np.all(np.isclose(aug[:, :-1], 0), axis=1))
38     if rank < n:
39         print("The system has infinitely many solutions.")
40     else:
41         print("The system has a unique solution:")
42         x = aug[:, -1]
43         print(x)
44     m = int(input("Enter the number of rows: "))
45     n = int(input("Enter the number of columns: "))
46
47     print("Enter the matrix A row by row, numbers separated by space:")
48     A = []
49     for i in range(m):
50         row = list(map(float, input(f"Row {i+1}: ").split()))
51         A.append(row)
52     A = np.array(A)
53
54     print("Enter the vector b (right-hand side), numbers separated by space:")
55     b = np.array(list(map(float, input().split())))
56
57     gauss_jordan(A, b)

```
